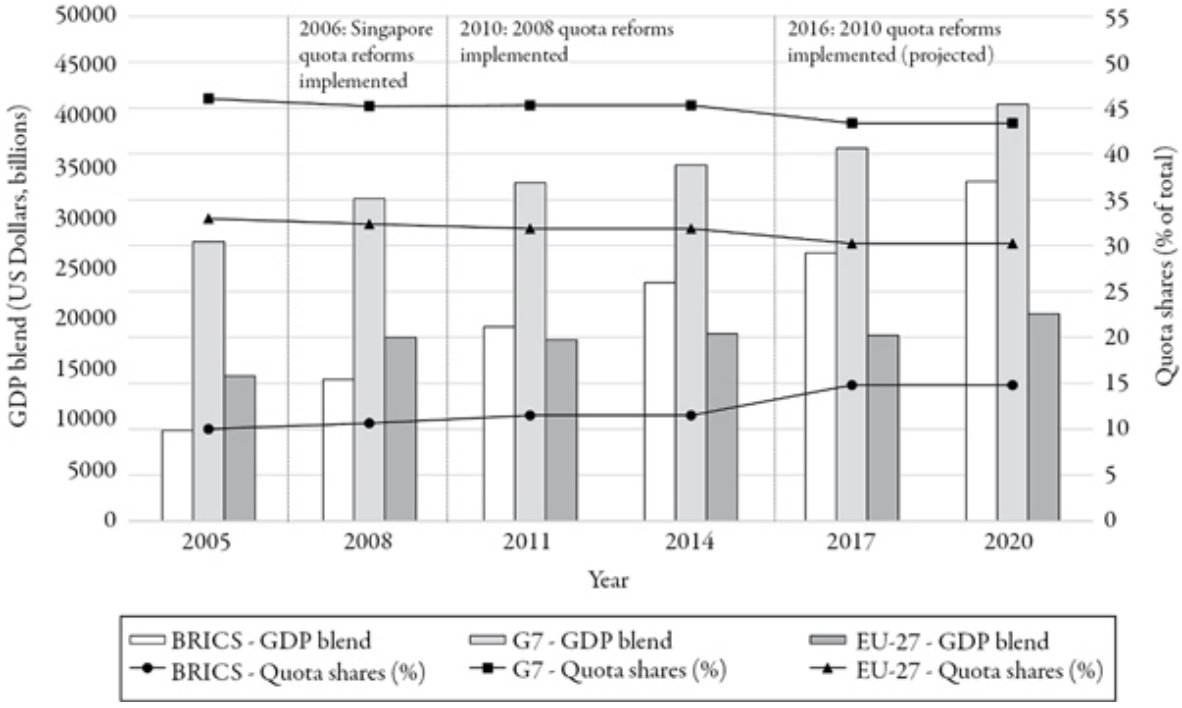


FIGURE 3.3 GDP Blend and IMF Quota Shares: BRICS, G7, and EU, 2005–2020

Source: IMF World Economic Outlook, April 2016 update; C. Roberts calculations.

The 14th General Review, finally implemented in 2016, marks an important readjustment of these imbalances, but many emerging economies believe that it does not go far enough. It shifts more than 6 percent of quota shares from overrepresented to underrepresented member countries, and more than 6 percent of quota shares to dynamic emerging market and developing countries (EMDCs). In the new realignment, China jumps from seventh to the third-largest member country in the IMF, after the United States and Japan, while Brazil, India, and Russia now rank in the top ten largest shareholders.[12] The same comparison of International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD) shareholding to the blended 60:40 economic weighting in the current IMF formula shows that the underweight examples from among the larger member countries include not only the largest BRICS—China (at 33 percent of economic weight), India (72 percent), and Brazil (74 percent)—but also the United States (83 percent).[13]

Despite periodic adjustments, most recently as part of the 2010 reforms, the United States still holds veto power with its 15 percent quota (representing its share of capital subscriptions and votes) in the World Bank